

PRODUCT BUSINESS CASE

Older Adults Digital Help Platform

AI-first support · Human escalation · Community-driven



UCD Professional Diploma in Digital Product Management · Merit · January 2025

Fillipe Gama · Product Marketing & Management

Technology left too many people behind

65%

of adults 65+ in Ireland experience some form of digital exclusion

97%

of online 45-59-year-olds own a smartphone — yet confidence is low

32%

of 60-74-year-olds have changed device settings - a clear skills gap

Sources: CSO Ireland 2023 · National Research Council · DESI 2023

The question wasn't how to reinvent the wheel.

It was: how do we make it roll for the people being left behind?

What they had

Smartphones. Devices. Apps installed by family. A desire to be independent and connected.

What they lacked

Confidence. Patient, jargon-free help on demand. A trusted place to ask 'silly' questions.

A two-tier platform built on a single principle: trust

TIER 1 · AI ASSISTANT

- Instant, step-by-step answers for common tech questions
- Available 24/7 - no waiting, no judgement
- Plain language, no jargon, written for the target audience
- Learns from the most frequent questions helpers answer

escalate

TIER 2 · HUMAN HELPERS

- Complex or emotional questions escalated to verified helpers
- Up to 3 community helpers answer each question
- User picks the most helpful answer. Quality is rewarded
- Tip system: helpers earn up to €15; platform retains 20%

AI for speed · Humans for trust · Both designed for the people technology has too often left behind

Designed from the ground up for 45–80-year-olds



Senior-first UI

Large text, minimal steps, high contrast - tested with the target audience



AI instant answers

Instant responses to common questions before escalating to humans



Community helpers

Verified helpers compete to give the clearest, most empathetic answer



Freemium access

1 free question/week ensures no-one is excluded by cost



Curated tutorials

Evergreen guides co-created with strategic partners (libraries, Age Action)



Gamified incentives

Helper badges, tip earnings, and reputation scores drive quality contributions

Don't ask people to trust a platform first

Build trust in the real world — then bring them online.

Partnerships

- Phone shops & tech repair stores as frontline referral points
- Libraries & community centres for face-to-face onboarding
- Healthcare facilities reaching the most vulnerable users
- Non-profits (Age Action) lending credibility and reach

Online Channels

- Google Ads targeting 'how to use phone' high-intent searches
- Facebook Ads reaching both older adults and adult children
- App store ads for install growth
- Referral programme: users earn rewards for inviting others

Offline Presence

- Libraries, posters, QR codes, workshops
- Community centres, flyers, staff referrals
- Phone shops — staff-led introduction at point of purchase
- Healthcare settings, trusted entry point for older adults

Freemium at the core — multiple paths to revenue

€7.99/mo

Monthly plan

Unlimited questions (fair use)

€79/yr

Annual plan

Best value for frequent users

€6.99–€11.99

Question packs

5 or 10 questions, no commitment

20% fee

Tip commission

Retained from tips up to
€15/answer

Free tier: 1 question per week — no credit card, no commitment. Designed to build trust before asking for payment.

Year 1	500	€48,000	(€23,000)
Year 2	1,500	€144,000	€94,000
Year 3	3,000	€288,000	€233,000

Strong ROI — break-even by Year 2

137%

ROI (3-Year)

Total net profit vs total investment

€132,716

NPV @ 10%

Positive - project exceeds cost of capital

38–42%

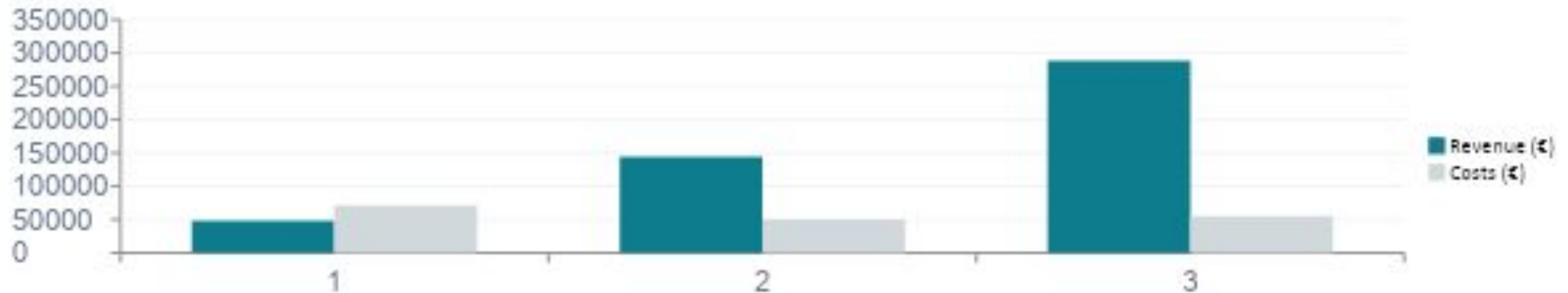
IRR

Significantly exceeds typical thresholds

~2.3 yrs

Payback Period

Investment recovered between Y2 and Y3



12 weeks from discovery to live product

Discovery <i>Wks 1-3</i>	Define <i>Wk 4</i>	Design <i>Wks 5-6</i>	Build <i>Wks 7-10</i>	GTM <i>Wks 11-12</i>	Measure <i>Wks 13-14</i>
User research, personas, JTBD, market validation	Feature spec, value prop, KPIs, team setup	Wireframes, UI, UX testing, tutorial drafts	Core platform, AI integration, payments, admin	Soft launch, partner onboarding, early users	Feedback, fixes, KPI report, evolution mapping

The most important decision wasn't choosing to add AI.

It was knowing when to hand back to a human.

Good product thinking isn't always about inventing something new.
Sometimes it's about making the wheel roll for the people who were never given a turn.

